

JOBS

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Marketing Engineer

4 candidates

OPEN

E2E Test Job 1776465882

1 candidate

DRAFT

E2E Test Job 1776465721

DRAFT

CEO

6 candidates

OPEN

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CEO

Completed

Submitted Apr 19, 2026



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Shortlist

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Behavioural assessment summary

Analysis computed Apr 19, 2026



Re-analyse

ROLE-FIT READ

Strong fit

OVERALL CONFIDENCE

**Rich signal — strong positive
convergence**

Four behavioural items scored with strong convergence across dimensions; conscientiousness and honesty-humility carry rich signal, while composure and learning are moderate, but all signals align in the same direction.

The integrity and follow-through this candidate brings are well-matched to the accountability demands of a CEO seat, where trust erodes fast and execution gaps are public. Staying grounded under pressure adds to that foundation without overpowering it.

This is a summary of observed signal against the hiring frame for this role. It is not

a hire/no-hire recommendation — an interview is required to make that call.

STRENGTHS

- ✓ When projections turned "materially wrong by about £340,000" after a contract fell through, the candidate in Part 3 called an emergency meeting rather than waiting, volunteering the error to the board unprompted and without minimising their role.
- ✓ In Part 5, the candidate reversed a regionally-backed expansion decision after a six-month employee raised NPS data that contradicted their own prior market analysis, acting on the challenge rather than dismissing it.
- ✓ In the Composure forced-choice pairs, the candidate consistently chose steady, grounded responses over reactive ones across both applicable items, suggesting they prioritise calm recovery when under pressure.
- ✓ In Part 1, when their CRM vendor collapsed six weeks into an eight-week rollout, the candidate kept a partially live team moving forward mid-migration — and in forced-choice pairs favoured this dimension in 4 of 6 applicable comparisons.

INTERVIEW FOCUS

1. *"You consistently chose composure-related options when the pressure was on in the assessment — both times it came up. I'd like to hear about a specific moment when staying steady was genuinely hard, not just uncomfortable. What was*

actually at stake, and what did you do in the hours right after things went wrong?"

Ranked by signal priority — high-severity flags first, then downgraded dimensions.

DIMENSION ESTIMATES

Learning Orientation

Strong positive signal

Composure

Moderate positive signal



Interpersonal Style

Insufficient signal



Honesty & Humility

Strong positive signal

Conscientiousness

Strong positive signal

FORCED-CHOICE PROFILE

Strongest preference toward
Conscientiousness and Honesty-Humility.
with Composure as a secondary signal.
Lower or no signal on Interpersonal Style.

► Scoring detail — for auditing ▼

MOTIVATIONAL PRIORITIES

Mission and Scope rank highest. Stability
ranks last of four.

INTEGRITY SCENARIO (C-T 2)

Option A: Share it tomorrow as
planned, flag the flaw clearly in the
meeting, and ask for time to fix it.

Honesty & Humility: +2

Conscientiousness: +1

INTERPERSONAL STYLE PROFILE

DIRECTNESS

Direct

CONFLICT APPROACH

Engages

REGARD FOR OTHERS

Respectful

FOLLOW-THROUGH

Tracked

BEHAVIOURAL RESPONSES

C-

s1 Think

about a

piece of

work in

the last 12

months

that you

were

personally

respo...

strong positive

1607 chars



C-

s2 Describe

a time in

the last

year or

two when

you

realized

you had

made a

signifi...

strong positive

1409 chars



C-

s3 Describe

a specific

time

when

someone

you

worked

strong positive

1353 chars



with
pushed
back on
something
y...

C-S4 Tell me
about a time you
had to deliver
feedback to
someone — a
peer, a report, ...

profile 1585 chars ▼

This report is a structured summary of a short assessment. It is not a psychological evaluation. Use alongside, not in place of, interviews and work samples.

Background

COVER LETTER

I have spent the past eight years building and scaling organisations in the education and social enterprise space. As COO of Elevate Learning, I took us from 12 staff and £1.2m revenue to 47 staff and £5.8m over four years, while maintaining our Ofsted 'Outstanding' rating throughout. I understand what it means to hold quality and growth in tension, and I have done it repeatedly. YFS sits at exactly the intersection I find most compelling: rigorous pedagogy, entrepreneurial culture, and real impact on young people who don't always get

access to this kind of environment. I want to build something that lasts.

Role-specific answers

CEO

QUESTION 1

What does excellent performance in the CEO role look like in the first 90 days, and how would you deliver it?

In the first 30 days, I listen before I lead. I would conduct structured interviews with every direct report, key funders, and at least 10 current or recent students. I would map the three or four decisions that are genuinely stuck and understand why. By day 60, I would have a clear picture of where we are strong, where we are fragile, and what the next 12 months need to look like. By day 90, I would have produced a single-page strategic frame agreed with the board, proposed a rhythm for how we communicate internally, and made at least one meaningful structural change that signals the pace and quality of decision-making I intend to set. Excellence in the first 90 days looks like credibility earned rather than authority asserted.

QUESTION 2

Tell us about a time you had to solve an ambiguous problem that is similar to the challenges in this CEO role. What did you do, and what changed because of your work?

When I joined Elevate Learning, student retention was at 61% and nobody could tell me exactly why students were dropping out. The data was fragmented across three systems and nobody owned the synthesis. I

spent six weeks rebuilding the data picture from scratch — not by commissioning a report but by sitting in on sessions, calling former students, and pulling raw exports from the CRM myself. What I found was counterintuitive: the highest dropout rate was in our most popular programme, because students felt it was too easy and they were wasting their time. We redesigned the challenge curve of that programme, added a peer mentorship component, and within two cohorts retention climbed to 84%. The learning was that ambiguous problems almost always have a concrete cause buried underneath. You just have to be willing to go find it yourself rather than wait for someone to bring it to you.

QUESTION 3

Describe the strongest proof of work you would point to for this CEO application, and explain why it matters.

The strongest proof of work I would point to is the restructuring of Elevate's delivery model in 2022. We had grown by adding headcount every time demand increased, which meant our margin was eroding even as revenue grew. I proposed and executed a transition to a hub-and-facilitator model, where we trained external facilitators to deliver certain programmes under our quality framework, while keeping our core staff focused on curriculum design and QA. This was operationally complex — it required rebuilding our training system, our quality monitoring, and our contracts infrastructure from scratch. It was also unpopular internally because it felt like a threat to existing roles. I took the time to explain the reasoning, restructured two roles rather than eliminating them, and tied the model change to a pay review for core staff.

Twelve months later, margin was up 11 points and we had expanded into three new regions without hiring a single additional full-time delivery person. That is the kind of structural thinking I would bring to YFS.

QUESTION 4

If you joined YFS in this CEO role next month, what would you stop, start, and improve first?

Stop: I would stop any recurring meetings that do not have a clear owner, decision, or output. In my experience, organisations of YFS's size often have an accumulation of inherited rhythms that nobody questions.

Start: I would start a monthly student advisory session — direct, unfiltered input from current participants about what is and is not working. Improve: I would improve how progress is communicated to funders and partners. Not by producing more reports, but by identifying the two or three metrics that actually matter to each stakeholder and making those visible in real time wherever possible.

QUESTION 5

Describe a project where you had to earn trust across stakeholders with different priorities. How did you do it?

At Elevate, we were building a new programme with three co-funders who each had different theories of change. The DfE wanted measurable attainment outcomes. The local authority cared about community integration. Our charitable trust funder cared about young people's sense of agency and self-belief. These were not incompatible, but they required careful translation. I set up a joint steering group that met quarterly, but more importantly I set up individual relationships with each funder's lead contact where I could have honest conversations

about what we were learning and what was hard. By the end of the programme, all three renewed. The key was that I never tried to make the same case to all three — I understood what each of them actually cared about and showed them evidence in that language.

QUESTION 6

What trade-offs would you make when speed, quality, and resource constraints collide in this kind of role?

In a role like this, the most common collision is between moving fast enough to maintain momentum and maintaining the quality that makes YFS worth attending. My approach is to protect quality at the level of what students actually experience, and to be willing to compromise on everything upstream of that — internal processes, reporting formats, even how we present to partners. If the student experience is strong, everything else can be rebuilt. If we sacrifice quality at the delivery level to hit a growth number, we erode the thing that makes us worth growing.

QUESTION 7

Tell us about a time you improved a broken process. What was wrong, what changed, and how did you measure the improvement?

At Elevate, our admissions process was broken in a way nobody wanted to say out loud: we were accepting students who were not ready for our programmes because we needed the revenue, and it was undermining outcomes for everyone. I named the problem explicitly in a team meeting, which was uncomfortable. Then I worked with the head of admissions to design a clearer readiness rubric and a parallel 'preparation pathway' for students who were close but

not quite ready. We piloted it for one term. Dropout in the affected cohorts fell from 34% to 11%. The process improvement was technical, but the breakthrough was having the courage to name what was actually happening first.

QUESTION 8

What parts of this CEO role play to your strengths, and where would you need to learn quickly?

My strengths in this role are strategic clarity, stakeholder navigation, and building internal cultures that are honest about what is working and what is not. I have done this in education contexts before and I know the terrain. Where I would need to learn quickly is the specifics of YFS's programmes — the pedagogy, the partnerships, the community — and I would prioritise that in my first 60 days. I would also want to understand the funding landscape more deeply, particularly any constraints or opportunities that are specific to YFS's positioning.

QUESTION 9

Describe a moment when you showed unusual ownership or agency without being asked. What happened?

In early 2021, our CRM vendor announced they were being acquired and our contract would not be renewed with six months' notice. Nobody had flagged this as a risk because our account manager had given us informal reassurances that turned out to be wrong. I found out at 9pm on a Tuesday when I saw the press release. By the following morning I had mapped our three most viable migration options, drafted a risk brief for the board, and had a preliminary call with two alternative vendors. I did not wait to be asked. I knew that if I let this sit it would become a crisis rather than a

managed transition. We completed the migration on time and under budget.

QUESTION 10

Using this added context, Running the whole organisation, describe how you would approach the most important challenge in this role.

The most important challenge in running a small organisation like YFS is making sure that growth does not erode the thing that makes it special. The risk is that as you add structure, hire more people, and respond to funders' reporting requirements, you slowly build a machine that produces outputs rather than an environment that produces genuine transformation. My approach would be to stay close to students throughout — not as a symbolic gesture but as a genuine source of signal. And to be honest with the board and with myself when I see drift happening, even when the metrics still look good.

Standard questions

Q1

Tell us about a time you identified a problem no one else had noticed and took initiative to solve it. What did you do and what happened?

When I joined Elevate, I noticed that our longest-serving facilitators were consistently delivering better outcomes than newer hires, but nobody had documented what they were doing differently. I proposed a peer observation programme where senior facilitators shadowed newer ones and captured their practice in structured notes. What emerged was a set of facilitation patterns — about how to handle conflict, how to re-engage disengaged students,

how to pace a session — that had never been written down. I turned these into a facilitation handbook that became part of our onboarding. New facilitator retention improved by 40% in the first year, partly because people felt more supported and less lost.

Q2

Describe a project or goal you worked on that did not go as planned. How did you respond and what did you learn?

In 2020 I led the launch of a digital programme that I was convinced would be transformative. I had designed it carefully, consulted with students, and the team was excited. It launched to 60 participants and within three weeks the completion rate was under 20%. I had fundamentally misread how this cohort wanted to learn. They needed human contact and accountability, and a self-paced digital format was wrong for them regardless of the content quality. I paused the programme, spoke directly to participants, and rebuilt it as a blended model with live sessions. I also wrote an honest post-mortem that I shared with the whole team. The rebuild worked — completion climbed to 78% — but the original failure was mine, and I had to own it clearly before we could move forward.

Q3

What is one skill or area of knowledge you have taught yourself in the past two years? Why did you pursue it and how did you go about it?

Over the past two years I have taught myself financial modelling well enough to build our own three-year forecast model rather than outsourcing it to our finance consultant. I realised that every time I relied on someone else to model scenarios, I was one step

removed from understanding the decisions. I learned by doing — building models, breaking them, asking the consultant to review them and explain what I had got wrong. I am not a finance expert, but I now understand our numbers well enough to stress-test assumptions myself and to have honest conversations with the board about risk without needing an interpreter.

Q4

Describe a situation where you disagreed with someone more senior than you. How did you handle it and what was the outcome?

Our board chair was convinced we should apply for a particular government grant that would have required us to significantly alter our delivery model. I thought the terms were wrong for us — the reporting burden was heavy, the geographic constraints would limit our best partnerships, and the reputational fit was awkward. I said so, clearly and directly, in a board meeting. I had prepared a one-page brief showing the cost-benefit analysis and the risks I was concerned about. The chair pushed back initially, but I held my position because I had the evidence. After further discussion, the board agreed not to apply. We subsequently found a better-fit funder who gave us more flexibility and a stronger relationship. Disagreement done well is one of the most valuable things a leadership team can do.

Q5

What is the most ambitious thing you have attempted, regardless of whether it succeeded? What drove you to try it?

The most ambitious thing I have attempted was proposing and then delivering a complete restructure of Elevate's delivery model while maintaining operations

throughout. We moved from a headcount-based model to a hub-and-facilitator model in 18 months without a single programme cancellation. I was not certain it would work. There were moments when key staff considered leaving, when the technology did not behave as expected, and when funder confidence wobbled. What drove me to try it was the conviction that if we did not change the model, the organisation would slowly become less and less able to do the work it existed to do. The financial pressure would eventually force quality compromises. I would rather attempt a difficult change with honest intent than manage a slow decline with comfortable explanations.

Q6

Where do you want to be in five years, and how does this role connect to that path?

In five years I want to be leading an organisation that has demonstrated that high-quality entrepreneurship education can be both financially sustainable and genuinely transformative at scale. I am not attached to a particular title. What I care about is building something that proves the model works — that you can run a rigorous, values-driven programme, maintain financial discipline, and produce young people who go on to do things that matter. This role connects directly to that because YFS has the brand, the community, and the methodology to be that proof of concept. I want to be the person who takes it there.

Final reflection

I am applying because I believe YFS is doing something genuinely rare — building an

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 Sign out

environment where young people encounter real entrepreneurial thinking, not just inspiration. The combination of rigour, community, and practical focus is exactly what I would want to help scale. I bring eight years of building in this space, a track